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21 convicted of visa fraud, fined Dh25.21m

DUBAI

BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The Dubai Citizenship and Residency Prosecution has secured from the Dubai Citizenship and Residency Court a conviction and a fine totalling Dh25.21 million against 21 defendants of various nationalities involved in visa fraud.

The individuals were found guilty in one of the largest cases pertaining to the illegal use of residence visas to exploit people and operating phantom companies that they would abruptly close without regularising the status of the recruited workers.

The arrests followed extensive monitoring, follow-ups, and inspections of the firms' purported offices, which were subsequently found to be non-existent and established merely for the purpose of obtaining residence visas in a clandestine manner.

Deliberate intent

Counsellor Dr Ali Humaid Bin Khatem, Senior Advocate General and Head of the Citizenship and Residency Prosecution, said that the investigation covered 33 commercial establishments, which served as decoys for obtaining and misusing 385 residency visas. It was also found that most of the business licences under which the illegal establishments operated had been secured by furnishing fictitious addresses, pointing to a deliberate intent to undermine and exploit residency and labour regulations for unlawful gain.

Trump says Iran–Israel truce 'in effect' with no more attacks

UAE PRESIDENT HOPES FOR LASTING STABILITY IN CALL WITH IRANIAN LEADER

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump said Israel was going to "turn around" its jets and stop attacking Iran and their ceasefire was "in effect" yesterday after briefly faltering.

"Israel is not going to attack Iran. All planes will turn around and head home, while doing a friendly 'Plane Wave' to Iran," Trump, as he pressed both sides to abide by the ceasefire, posted on social media. "Nobody will be hurt, the ceasefire is in effect!"

Israel "refrained" from further strikes on Iran after the call between Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, the latter's office announced.

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, meanwhile, received a phone call from Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, during which he welcomed the announcement of the ceasefire agreement.

He expressed hope that the agreement would serve as a foundation for lasting stability, security and peace across the Middle East.

Not happy with Israel

Earlier, in comments to reporters at the White House before departing for the Nato summit at The Hague, Trump had expressed disappointment over the continued attacks.

"They violated it, but Israel violated it, too," Trump said. He added, "I'm not happy with Israel."

AFP

■ Life returns to normal in Tehran's Enghelab Square after the ceasefire took effect yesterday.

> **I didn't like the fact that Israel unloaded right after we made the deal. And now I hear Israel just went out because they felt violated by one rocket that didn't land anywhere."**
>
> **Donald Trump |** US President

"I didn't like the fact that Israel unloaded right after we made the deal," Trump said. "And now I hear Israel just went out because they felt violated by one rocket that didn't land anywhere."

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi confirmed that Iran would stop its attacks if Israel would. And Israel also confirmed that it had reached its aims of its operations and would cease hostilities.

But the tentative truce faltered yesterday when Israel accused Iran of launching missiles into its airspace after the ceasefire was supposed to take effect and vowed to retaliate.

Iran's military denied firing on Israel, state media reported. Several local media outlets reported the sound of explosions in Iran's north.

The US president then took to his Truth Social platform to warn Israel to end its attacks.

"Israel. Do not drop those bombs. If you do it is a major violation," Trump posted. "Bring your pilots home, now!"

— Agencies

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